

CHARLES HARLESS

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING MANAGER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineering Manager with 15+ years of experience leading engineering teams building web, mobile, and cloud platforms for Fortune 500 companies including Disney, Amazon, and NBCUniversal. Managed distributed teams delivering high-availability systems supporting millions of users. Aligned engineering execution with business strategy and transformed engineering performance through technical leadership, mentorship, and data-driven operational improvements.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Engineering Leadership • Distributed Systems Architecture • Streaming Media • Technical Roadmaps
Agile Development • AWS Cloud Platforms • Microservices • Java • React • CI/CD & DevOps

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Launched Disney Movies Anywhere with 3.5M mobile downloads for 20M+ users at launch
- Reduced engineering operational backlog by 75% through prioritization frameworks
- Increased deployment frequency by 20% through CI/CD pipelines and automation practices
- Led architectural improvements reducing application latency by 25% for distributed systems
- Strengthened engineering through mentorship and feedback improving team morale by 40%

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineering Manager Jan 2024 – Present

Thinking Bear Productions – Los Angeles, CA (remote)

- Advised organizations across 5 clients on distributed systems, cloud platforms, and strategy
- Improved Agile engineering practices resulting in 20% increases in team velocity
- Guided cloud infrastructure optimizations reducing AWS operating costs by 15%
- Publish articles on LinkedIn on technical architecture, cloud platforms, and team management

Computer Science Instructor Aug 2023 – Present

UCLA Extension – Los Angeles, CA (remote)

- Instructed 100 students across 10 classes in Java Programming and Data Structures, fostering understanding of object-oriented principles and software development practices
- Maintained a 4.7 / 5.0 instructor rating, reflecting student satisfaction with course content

Software Engineering Manager Jan 2023 – Jun 2023

Brightcove – Digital Media Engineering – Boston, MA (remote)

- Led 2 teams of 15 engineers building media management apps for 2,500+ enterprise customers
- Provided mentorship, performance feedback, and career development for engineering teams
- Reduced application latency by 25% while improving stability through architecture improvements
- Implemented prioritization framework reducing engineering backlog 75% within 1 month
- Boosted team engagement by 40% through constructive feedback and mentoring

Software Development Manager Jan 2021 – Jun 2022

Amazon Prime Video – Global Supply Chain – Culver City, CA (hybrid)

- Led engineering development of services managing 800+ streaming content contracts
- Created a data-driven prioritization framework improving engineering team velocity by 15%
- Defined engineering roadmap and 3-year strategy aligning engineering and business priorities
- Hired 2 engineers and promoted 2 engineers, strengthening team capability and career growth
- Coordinated security remediation rollout across 2,000+ applications completed within 1 week

Staff Software Engineer

Apr 2016 – Dec 2020

NBCUniversal – Workplace Collaboration – Universal City, CA (on-site)

- Managed team of 5 engineers developing mobile apps used by 23,000+ employees globally
- Enhanced push notifications increasing engagement by 10% while reducing opt-outs by 20%

Computer Science Instructor

Aug 2015 – Dec 2019

UCLA Extension – Los Angeles, CA (on-site)

- Instructed 100 students across 10 classes in Java Programming and Web Applications, fostering understanding of object-oriented principles and web services development
- Maintained a 4.7 / 5.0 instructor rating, reflecting student satisfaction with course content

Principal Software Engineer

May 2015 – Mar2016

Sage Software – Innovation Labs – Irvine, CA (hybrid)

- Led development of a cross-platform mobile framework supporting 5 enterprise products
- Authored engineering standards improving code quality and maintainability by 15%

Staff Software Engineer

Mar 2014 – Apr 2015

Walt Disney Studios – Technology Innovation Group – Burbank, CA (on-site)

- Developed mobile navigation prototype using Beacons improving visitor directions in studio buildings by 25%
- Prototyped a digital entitlement delivery system using Bitcoin and BitTorrent reducing entitlement delivery costs by 20%

Staff Software Engineer

Nov 2011 – Feb 2014

Walt Disney Studios – Distribution Technology – Burbank, CA (on-site)

- Launched Disney Movies Anywhere streaming platform with over 20M+ users and 3.5M mobile app downloads within the first month after launch
- Deployed high-availability streaming media apps maintaining 99.9% uptime for 4TB of data
- Delivered streaming infrastructure using adaptive bitrate streaming and DRM technologies

Senior Software Engineer

Dec 2005 – Oct 2011

Walt Disney Parks & Resorts – Glendale, CA (on-site)

- Led engineering development for 12 award-winning niche-market websites for consumers
- Produced LAMP architecture standards improving development speed and deployment by 30%

EDUCATION

- **Master of Science in Computer Science** – University of California Los Angeles
- **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science** – University of Alabama

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified **ScrumMaster** & Certified Scrum Product Owner - Scrum Alliance
- Generative AI Fundamentals Certificate - Databricks
- **AWS Cloud Practitioner** Essentials - Amazon Web Services

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Cloud Platforms:** AWS (Lambda, ECS, S3, API Gateway), Docker, CloudFormation
- **Streaming Media Systems:** HLS, DASH, DRM (Widevine & FairPlay), CDNs
- **Software Development:** Java, Spring, Node.js, JavaScript, TypeScript, React
- **Technical Architecture:** Microservices, Distributed Systems, REST APIs, CI/CD
- **Developer Tools:** GitHub, Jenkins, SQL, noSQL